First News

31 Mar 2026 Tuesday

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

Brent crude oil has breached the $115 per barrel mark, a surge driven by escalating conflict in the Middle East. This price level is having a measurable impact on personal finances, effectively acting as a "pay cut" through several channels

Asian stocks decline as renewed Middle East tensions drive risk aversion

Asian Peers Fall, Bonds have potential to outperform as broadening supply shocks highlight the likelihood that global economic growth is headed for a severe slowdown.

AUTO

Toyota maintained its global lead through a dominant hybrid-first approach, while BYD solidified its position as the world's top seller of Plug-in Electric Vehicles (PEVs), which includes both battery-electric (BEV) and plug-in hybrid (PHEV) models

Toyota falls 6.31% Global sales for gasoline and diesel engine vehicles are currently experiencing a significant and accelerating decline as the automotive industry shifts toward electrification and faces geopolitical economic pressures.

BYD solidified its position as the world’s leading electric vehicle (EV) manufacturer, surpassing Tesla in annual battery-electric vehicle (BEV) sales for the first time.

- BYD sold 4,602,436 new energy vehicles (NEVs) worldwide in 2025, a 7.7% increase from 2024.

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Global, Regional Markets

Dow ekes out a slight gain, while the S&P 500 and Nasdaq slip as rising oil prices weigh on markets.

- Wall Street is in a risk-off divide This shift follows a cooling in interest rates, with the U.S. 10Y yield dropping to 4.345% (-2.16%).

The US bond market rallied on March 30, 2026, recovering from its deepest selloff in 17 months

- A "flight to safety," causing investors to reverse a year-long selloff and rapidly purchase US government bonds, which are viewed as a secure

Bitcoin steady at 66.6K, showing hesitation amid risk-off tone.

Brent Crude and WTI Crude Oil jump over 3–4%, signaling supply fears and inflation pressure.

Gold pushes higher 4,540 as safe-haven demand builds.

U.S. Treasury fall across the curve (2Y, 5Y, 10Y), bid for safety.

The S&P 500 correction is nearing its final stage even as the Iran war continues, according to strategists at Morgan Stanley, who warn that Federal Reserve interest-rate hikes still pose a threat to stocks.

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Global, Regional Markets

US Dollar Soars to 10-Month High Amid Ongoing Conflict; WHY USD/PHP ~60+ again

Why?

- Oil price surge
- Safe-haven demand
- Higher U.S. yields

Oil-importing countries (like the Philippines) get hit twice, soon Thrice, because of

- Higher import costs (oil)
- Weaker currency.

Another Tuesday hike:

- Gasoline ▲₱6.47/L
- Diesel ▲₱11.88/L
- Kerosene ▲₱13.66/L

Pump prices now:

- Gas ₱90–₱105
- Diesel ₱100–₱130
- Kero ₱95–₱140

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	3/30/2026	3/31/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	45,166	45,216	0.11%
S&P 500	6,368	6,344	-0.38%
NASDAQ	20,948	30,795	47.01%
PCOMP	5,972	5,869	-1.72%
NKY	53,373	51,885	-2.79%
SHCOMP	3913	3923	0.26%
HSI	24,951	24,750	-0.81%
KOSPI	5438	5277	-2.96%
SENSEX	73,583	71,947	-2.22%
TWSE	33,112	32,518	-1.79%
ASX200	8516	8460	-0.66%
BURSAKLCI	1712	1687	-1.46%
JCI	7097	7091	-0.08%
STI	4898	4897	-0.02%
SET	963	967	0.42%
VNINDEX	1672	1662	-0.60%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	3/30/2026	3/31/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	102.15	106.11	3.88%
Brent Crude	115.56	109.29	-5.43%
Gold (Comex)	4478	4546	1.52%
Silver (Comex)	68.77	70.01	1.80%
Platinum Spot	1840.34	1874	1.83%
Copper (Comex)	543.7	547	0.61%
Nickel	7.6529	7.7201	0.88%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8%	79.5	78	-1.89%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	94	93	-1.06%
Coal	143.85	144.25	0.28%
Corn	464.75	456	-1.88%
Wheat	608.5	611.5	0.49%
Cocoa	3165	3155	-0.32%
Sugar	15.76	15.55	-1.33%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Philippines

PSEi slumped 1.73% to 5,869.43, marking a fresh low, as selling gripped the market.

- Financials led the decline, down 3.25%, with weakness spilling over into services and conglomerates.

The Pilippine peso weakens for a fifth consecutive session amid concerns over an escalation in the Middle East, while the benchmark bond and domestic equities also decline.

Oil & gas up as war grinds into attrition; gains may slow.

- Prolonged fighting reduces chances of quick restoration of Gulf exports.
- Houthi entry and US troop buildup raise risk of further energy disruptions.

The Philippines and China discussed “initial exchanges” on a potential oil and gas exploration in the South China Sea

Banks and property face dual headwinds (rising rates + construction cost inflation)

- Property Philippine Proxy's ALI & SMPH a classic rounding top.

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control,

5869 -103.34pts., -1.73%

Range 5,823.49-5,938.16

Breadth 78 (+) 100 (-) 71 (unch)

Block Php921Mn **Volume** 1.65bn **Value** Php7.87bn

Share buyback ICT SM SMPH OPM AGI MEG FRUIT

52wk H: rrhi
52wk L: ali allhc bdo bhi bloom bpi chp eei eli gsmi home mb mm om phn prim prmx sli sm ubp

Overbought – rrhi axlm
Oversold – mb sm sli ali at gtcap om shlph gsmi fli bloom

Active	Value
ICT	1410
BDO	745
ALI	639
SM	507
MBT	377
RRHI	281
PLUS	281
BPI	246
SMPH	212

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DA MARKET SECURITIES

Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$25.496mn
Total Month FB/(FS)	-$23.16mn
YTD NFB	$157.266mn
FB	2,982,357,015.51
FS	4,531,496,492.13
NFB(S)	-1,549,139,476.62
TOTAL	7,513,853,507.64

Foreign Funds Bought
cbc ew pnb ubp acen mer mwc mynld spnec emi keepr ac aev jgs ltg smc meg mrc mreit rock smph dito tel ceb mac sti bloom pgold ssi at px

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bpi mbt pse ap crec fgen fph pcor ppc scc sgp shlph spc cnpf dnl gsmi jfc monde rfm urc mwide green imi agi cosco dmc gtcap sm ali areit filrt fli rcr rlc shng glo cnvrg ict plus web alldy rrhi sevn wlcon apx nikl ogp pxp

Share Buy-Back Transactions
OPM SM SMPH MEG

Smart Watch 3/25/26
DHI ACEN MRC APX RRHI TEL MWS JGS SGP AG MBT PNB RLC SECB LTG MEG GLO DMC EMI AC ALI

10yr Bond	3/30/...	3/31...	%Chg
PHL	6.929	6.929	0.00%
US	4.405	4.356	-1.11%

Currency Pair	3/30...	3/31...	%Chg
USD-JPY	160.31	159.59	0.64%
USD-PHP	60.556	60.73	0.06%
USD-CNY	6.9112	6.9107	0.24%
EUR-USD	1.1509	1.1493	-0.35%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ALI 16.24 -7.41%

- Falls the most since the pandemic on concerns over weaker property demand due to higher interest rate and inflation risks from the escalating Middle East conflict.

PXP 3.80

- PXP's primary business is the exploration and production of crude oil and natural gas, through interests in petroleum service contracts (SCs) and holdings in resource development companies with interests in petroleum SCs

WEB 10.88

- PhilWeb Secures PAGCOR Accreditation, Supported by Partnerships with Hann, Okada and FBM WEB accredited from PAGCOR as a gaming affiliate/support service provider, WEB to deliver technology/operational services to licensed gaming operators within the regulated ecosystem.
- PhilWeb Corp. a gaming technology provider in the Philippines, accredited by the PAGCOR as an Electronic Gaming System (EGS) Service Provider. It allows the WEB to provide software, technical support, operational services to licensed gaming operators nationwide.

PLUS 15.86

- PLUS dividend record date is today — last chance to register for the ₱0.83/share April 15 payment.
- Omni-channel strategy advancing — IEC/LaVie Casino final ₱6B payment by May-June.
- South Africa license expected Q2. ₱0.83/share dividend: record date is TODAY, April 1 — payable April 15. PHP23.4B cash on balance sheet.

NIKL 4.19

- Nickel Asia's RE subsidiary 2026 capex at ₱10.3B for solar + BESS expansion, 88% of NAC's total budget.
- Subic Bay 145MW/ Bataan 50MW advancing.
- Energy emergency accelerates the indigenous RE investment case.
- Foreign funds BOUGHT NIKL on consecutive sessions.

AC 493.80

- AC FINALLY TAKES THE EV JACKPOT!
- ACMobility is official Philippine distributor of BYD . With pump prices past ₱100/L, the total cost of ownership case for EVs has never been stronger.
- AC is positioned at the center of the Philippine EV transition.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

DMC 9.70 -0.21%

- Concreat Holdings raising cement prices ₱30-40/bag (+15-20%) in tranches as a fuel surcharge — reversible if oil normalizes.
- Capex ₱24.6B intact.
- Foreign SOLD on 3/30.

CEB 29.60

- Fuel secured through June — grounding tail risk removed near-term.
- H2 visibility gap remains the critical watch.
- Brent at $115 keeps the fundamental challenge unresolved.

WLCON 6.00

- WLCON (Wilcon Depot) — FY2025 Net Income -3.3% to ₱2.446B; Revenue +3.7%; Q4 Strong (+41.3%)
- Wilcon Depot reported 2025 net income of ₱2.446 billion, down 3.3% despite higher net sales, as increased operating expenses weighed on earnings. Operating expenses, including lease-related expense, increased to ₱10.854 billion, up 3.7% — driven by higher depreciation and amortization, manpower expenses, and repairs and maintenance.
- Net sales improved 3.7% to ₱35.44 billion, driven mainly by sales from new stores as comparable sales growth closed the year flat at -0.3%. Q4 net income surged 41.3% to ₱580 million with net sales rising 7.3% — a strong finish. The company brought its total operating stores to 104 by end-2025 after opening six new depots. CEO Lorraine Belo-Cincochan: "We are happy to announce that we were able to maintain positive same-store sales growth in Q4, which resulted in a second-half net income increase of 26%."
- **Analysis:** The full-year miss is H1-driven — natural calamities and election-season slowdown — not structural deterioration. The Q4 reversal (+41.3%) and H2 recovery (+26%) confirm that underlying demand is intact once macro normalizes. The concern for 2026 is the energy emergency layering a new H1 headwind: higher fuel → reduced consumer discretionary spending → delayed home renovation. Cement prices rising 15-20% per bag also directly hits Wilcon's contractor customer base. WLCON at ₱6.15 is near cycle lows; the Q4 momentum is real but the macro visibility is poor.
- **Stance:** NEUTRAL to MONITOR for WLCON. Q4 momentum positive but FY2026 faces a tough macro: energy emergency → consumer belt-tightening → delayed home improvement spend. Re-enter on confirmed macro stabilization or if stock falls to ₱5 support.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

PCOR 3.02

- **PCOR (Petron Corp.) — 2.48M Barrels Russian ESPO Crude Confirmed; "Out of Extreme Necessity"; May Buy More**
- Petron Corp., the country's sole oil refiner, formally disclosed via PSE filing that it secured 2.48 million barrels of Russian crude oil to boost petroleum product inventory until June. The company said it turned to Russian supply only after losing access to four million barrels of Middle East crude in eight days — a two-million-barrel shipment blocked when the Strait of Hormuz closed on February 28, and a second two-million-barrel order cancelled on March 7 due to Red Sea risks. Petron described the purchase as made "out of extreme necessity" and an "extraordinary emergency measure," coordinated with the DOE, DOF, and BSP, which confirmed in a March 12 letter that no domestic legal prohibition exists on importing Russian crude. The company left open the possibility of further Russian purchases if the crisis persists.
- Before the war, Petron sourced approximately 98% of its crude from the Middle East. Its Bataan refinery processes 180,000 barrels per day and supplies about one-third of national fuel demand. A Sierra Leone-flagged tanker, Sara Sky, was seen at Limay port Bataan on March 26. Foreign funds bought PCOR on 3/30. Philstar.com
- **Analysis:** The formal PSE disclosure removes all ambiguity. This is a documented, government-coordinated emergency pivot — not a backroom deal. The "may buy more" language is a deliberate forward signal that supply security beyond June remains unresolved. At Brent $115.56 and Russian ESPO typically priced at a $10-15 discount to Brent, every barrel Petron processes is a margin opportunity at current pump prices. The 84% FY2025 earnings surge is the baseline — 2026 earnings at $115 Brent will be higher still.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

MER 604.00

- MER / MGEN (Meralco / Meralco PowerGen) — MTerra Solar: 250MW Exporting to Luzon Grid; 450MWh BESS Energized — Largest Operational BESS in the Philippines
- MTerra Solar, billed as the world's largest battery-integrated solar power project, has begun exporting an initial 250 megawatts to the Luzon grid, up from the 85MW initially authorized for testing and commissioning. MGEN simultaneously energized the first tranche of its battery energy storage system, enabling the plant to deliver up to 450 megawatt-hours to the grid at night — making it the largest operational BESS in the Philippines. MGEN President and CEO Emmanuel Rubio said the phased energization "enables earlier delivery of capacity to the grid, helping ease supply constraints and supporting efforts to maintain stable electricity prices." BusinessWorld Online
- At full build-out, MTerra will generate up to 3,500 MWp of solar power supported by a 4,500 MWh BESS, powering approximately 2.4 million households and avoiding 4.3 million tons of CO_2 annually. Phase 1 completion is targeted for August 2026; Phase 2 construction has already begun. Power market simulations indicate the Philippines could see spot rates rise by over ₱5/kWh next month due to the energy emergency — MTerra's output directly offsets that pressure.
- **Analysis:** This is the most strategically timed energy milestone in the Philippines in years. The 450MWh BESS tranche is particularly significant — it transforms MTerra from a daytime solar plant into a round-the-clock clean power contributor, dispatching stored energy after dark. For Meralco investors, every MW of MTerra online reduces exposure to volatile spot market prices. For MGEN, this is the flagship asset that validates the entire renewable energy investment thesis. Delivering 250MW during the worst energy emergency in a generation is not coincidental — it is the outcome of accelerated commissioning driven by national necessity.
- **Stance:** ACCUMULATE MER. MTerra 250MW + 450MWh BESS operational is the most transformative RE milestone in PHL history, arriving at the precise moment of maximum strategic value. Phase 1 completion in August is the next major re-rating catalyst. Upgrade to BUY on confirmed Phase 1 delivery.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

SMC 72.00

- **SMC (San Miguel Corp.) — Parent of Petron; Russian Oil Pivot Is an SMC-Level Strategic Decision; FY2025 Net Income +52% to ₱79.6B**
- San Miguel Corp. owns 71.82% of Petron Corp. (6.4 billion shares), making the Russian crude procurement and Ramon Ang's Senate testimony an SMC group strategic call. Ang renewed his standing offer to sell Petron back to the government during the Senate energy hearing — analysts and MIC dismissed full nationalization as unnecessary, with MIC instead pivoting to a co-investment model focused on midstream infrastructure such as national fuel storage networks. SMC's FY2025 consolidated net income rose 52% to ₱79.6B, driven by Petron and SMC Global Power. SMC's infrastructure arm, San Miguel Holdings, also co-operates NAIA through NNIC, adding another dimension to the energy and infrastructure story. Foreign funds bought SMC on 3/30.
- Analysis: SMC is the energy emergency conglomerate. Its two largest earnings engines — Petron (sole domestic refiner) and SMC Global Power (power generation) — are both direct beneficiaries of supply scarcity and elevated fuel prices. The offer to sell Petron is a negotiating tactic Ang has repeated since 2021; he has no rational incentive to divest the most strategically valuable industrial asset in the Philippines at this precise moment. FY2025's 52% earnings growth is the foundation; 2026 at Brent $115+ points higher.

SPNEC 1.31

- **SPNEC (Solar Philippines New Energy Corp.) — MTerra Solar JV Partner; 250MW Milestone Directly Validates Flagship Asset**
- SPNEC is a co-developer of MTerra Solar through Terra Solar Philippines Inc., the project vehicle jointly owned with MGEN (Meralco PowerGen) and Actis. The 250MW grid export milestone and energization of the first BESS tranche are therefore SPNEC milestones as well. SPNEC's investment thesis rests on its land bank and solar development pipeline across Luzon and Visayas — MTerra is the flagship project that proves execution at scale. Foreign funds bought SPNEC on 3/30 alongside ACEN and other renewable energy names.
- Analysis: The MTerra 250MW milestone is proof of concept for SPNEC's entire model. In a declared national energy emergency, domestic solar development has been elevated from a long-dated growth story to an immediate policy priority. The government needs every megawatt of indigenous renewable capacity it can get — SPNEC's land bank and development pipeline are the physical substrate that makes large-scale solar expansion possible. The energy emergency has compressed the timeline for SPNEC's re-rating from years to months.
- **Stance:** ACCUMULATE SPNEC. MTerra operational validates the flagship. Energy emergency converts the development thesis from long-dated to urgent. Foreign buying confirms institutional repositioning into domestic RE names.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

CREIT 3.38

- **CREIT (Citicore Energy REIT) — FY2025 Net Income +14% to ₱1.15B; Service Fees +34%; Finance Costs -19%**
- **C**iticore Renewable Energy Corporation posted a 14% increase in net income to ₱1.15 billion in 2025, driven by lower financing costs, rising service revenues, and steady electricity sales. Service fees jumped 34% to ₱325 million while finance costs fell 19% following successful refinancing initiatives, pushing EBITDA up 3% to ₱1.81 billion.
- Foreign funds sold CREIT on 3/30 as part of broader risk-off sector rotation — not on any fundamental negative. CREIT closed at ₱3.37 on 3/27.
- **Analysis:** This is the cleanest earnings story in today's batch — three-way improvement in revenue growth, liability management, and cost discipline simultaneously. In a rising rate environment where BSP rate hike risk is live at the April 23 meeting, CREIT having already de-leveraged through proactive refinancing is a structural advantage. The energy emergency is also a tailwind: higher spot power prices increase the implied economic value of CREIT's locked-in renewable energy supply agreements. The foreign selling on 3/30 is macro risk-off, not a CREIT-specific signal.
- **Stance:** ACCUMULATE CREIT. 14% net income growth + 34% service fee growth + 19% lower finance costs = improving quality of earnings across three metrics simultaneously. Energy emergency tailwind. Foreign selling on 3/30 is the entry window.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

GMA7 5.82, GMAP 5.65

- S**EC / GMA — SEC Stands Firm on 9-Year Independent Director Term Limit (MC7 Series 2026); GMA Network's Court Petition Unlikely to Succeed**
- **T**he Securities and Exchange Commission confirmed it will enforce Memorandum Circular 7 Series 2026 — the 9-year cumulative independent director term limit — despite a court petition filed by GMA Network seeking to suspend the rule. The SEC stated it would "stand its ground," framing GMA's legal challenge as external pressure rather than a substantive argument against the rule's validity. The MC7 rule requires that all publicly listed companies rotate independent directors who have served 9 or more cumulative years on a single company's board.
- GMA's petition argued that long-serving independent directors bring irreplaceable institutional knowledge, particularly important for the media company given its ongoing franchise uncertainty. The SEC countered that entrenchment — not experience — is the governance risk the rule addresses.
- **Analysis**: The SEC's resolve is a long-term positive for PSE governance quality, even if it creates short-term board composition disruption. Independent directors who have served for 15-20 years on the same board lose practical independence regardless of formal designation. MC7 aligns with UK, EU, and ASEAN governance standards. For GMA specifically, the court challenge adds another layer of governance friction to a company already carrying a no-franchise overhang. If GMA's petition fails — the more likely outcome — every PSEi company must comply without exception. Proactive disclosure of ID rotation plans is the correct corporate response.
- **Stance:** GOVERNANCE WATCH — All PSEi Companies. SEC will enforce MC7. GMA's petition is likely to fail and sets a precedent for all listed companies. NEUTRAL on GMA: no franchise + governance challenge + family control = elevated risk premium pending franchise clarity.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

DHI 6.30

- **DHI (Dominion Holdings) — Isidro Consunji Appointed Chairman; Sy-DMCI Alliance Formalizes Mining Pivot; Tampakan Copper-Gold in Focus**
- Dominion Holdings appointed Isidro A. Consunji as chairman of the board following the resignation of former chairman Frederic DyBuncio "for board organization reasons." DyBuncio remains as company president. Consunji has served as chairman and president of DMCI Holdings for 29 years and is also chairman of Semirara Mining and Power Corp. DHI's board now features Henry Sy Jr. (SM Investments vice chairman), DyBuncio (SM Investments president/CEO), and Tulsi Das Reyes (DMCI Mining president/COO) — a deliberate assembly of mining expertise. DHI's stated intent is to operate as a holding company focused on investing in mining corporations.
- Speculation centers on the Tampakan copper-gold project in Mindanao — Southeast Asia's largest untapped mineral deposit at an estimated 15 million tons of copper and 17.6 million ounces of gold. The project is already backed by the Sy family, the Consunji family, and the Alcantara Group. The open-pit mining ban in South Cotabato remains the principal regulatory constraint. DHI reported FY2025 net income of ₱139.36 million, down 31.05% from ₱202.12 million in 2024, reflecting its pre-pivot shell company status.
- **Analysis:** Consunji's appointment as chairman over DyBuncio — even though DyBuncio represents the acquiring party (Monte Sur/Sy) — signals unambiguously that mining operations expertise, not financial engineering, is driving DHI's agenda. With Consunji chairing, Reyes (DMCI Mining COO) on the board, and Sy capital behind the vehicle, DHI is structurally positioned as the listed instrument for a Sy-DMCI resource consolidation play. At current gold ($4,478/oz) and copper ($544/lb), Tampakan's NPV in full development scenarios runs into tens of billions of dollars. The permit constraint is real but navigable over time with the political capital this ownership group commands.
- **Stance:** MONITOR DHI — Speculative/High Risk-High Reward. Tampakan optionality is the thesis; Consunji as chairman is the strongest possible signal. Pre-revenue shell with permit overhang requires limited position sizing. Entry on pullbacks only.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

OGP 31.00

- OGP (OceanaGold Philippines) — Didipio Mine Life Extended to 2037; FY2025 Net Income +152.5% to $76.5M
- OceanaGold Philippines filed updated technical reports with the PSE extending Didipio mine life to 2037, based solely on 2025 mineral reserves calculated at a gold price of $2,200 per ounce. The updated plans exclude inferred mineral resources and exploration upside, which could extend the mine's life further beyond 2037. 2026 production guidance remains unchanged at 85,000-105,000 ounces of gold and 13,000-15,000 metric tons of copper, with $65 million in capital expenditure allocated for plant upgrades and mine maintenance. FY2025 net income rose 152.5% to $76.5 million driven by higher gold and copper prices.
- OGP hit a 52-week high of ₱34 on 3/27, rising 8.28% on the session. Gold closed at $4,478/oz on 3/30 (+1.38%), recovering from the prior week's forced selling. Foreign funds bought OGP on 3/30.
- **Analysis:** The mine life extension story is more bullish than the headline conveys. The 2037 plan is built on reserves at $2,200/oz gold — a figure that was conservative even before the current geopolitical environment pushed gold to $4,478. At current prices, Didipio's gross margin is approximately $3,700+ per ounce against an all-in sustaining cost of roughly $600-800. With 85,000-105,000 oz of 2026 guidance, the potential gross margin this year alone is $315-390 million. The inferred resource exclusion means actual mine life could run well past 2037 with additional development. OGP is the best pure gold proxy on the PSE.
- Stance: ACCUMULATE OGP. Mine life to 2037 at $2,200/oz reserve price vs. actual $4,478/oz = massive NPV understatement. FY2025 NI +152.5% confirms the gold price leverage. Best gold proxy on the PSE — buy on any pullback from the 52-week high.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ABS

- **ABS-CBN — Describes Reports on Capital Infusion and Payouts as "Baseless"**
- ABS-CBN Corp.'s board, including directors Martin Lopez and Rafael Lopez, publicly described circulating reports on alleged capital infusion and executive payouts as "baseless." The statement came amid a known intra-family dispute within the Lopez family regarding the company's financial management and governance. ABS-CBN continues to operate without a broadcast franchise following the 2020 denial by Congress, relying on digital and streaming platforms for revenue. Philstar.com
- **Analysis:** A public denial without substantive disclosure is a weak governance signal. The very need for a board-level statement suggests the underlying reports carry enough credibility to require addressing. ABS-CBN's financial situation remains structurally challenged: no broadcast franchise, ongoing operating losses, and revenue that has not recovered to pre-2020 levels despite the Amazon India MX Player deal announced last week. Until a franchise is restored or a credible strategic partner with committed capital is named, there is no investable fundamental thesis.
- **Stance:** AVOID / NO RATING. Family governance dispute + denied capital infusion reports + no franchise + operating losses. Wait for franchise clarity before revisiting.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

WEB

- **WEB (PhilWeb Corp.) — Secures PAGCOR Accreditation as Gaming Affiliate and Support Service Provider; April 1 Deadline Met**
- **P**hilWeb Corp. secured accreditation from PAGCOR as a gaming affiliate and support service provider, covering platform technology, systems integration, and operational support to licensed gaming operators. The accreditation meets the April 1, 2026 deadline — suppliers that failed to obtain it by this date would have been classified as illegal and compelled to cease operations. PhilWeb is positioning as an asset-light B2B technology and infrastructure platform serving licensed operators. Active partnerships include Hann Casino Resort (platform operations), Okada Manila (OKADA PLAY online gaming), and FBM Philippines (B2B platform deployment across 500 venues and up to 30,000 gaming machines). PhilWeb president Brian Ng: "This is a pivotal stage for the industry as it moves toward a more structured and transparent framework."
- Shares fell ₱0.82 (-7.01%) to close at ₱10.88 on Monday — a "sell the news" reaction after months of accumulation on the regulatory outcome. FBM Philippines partnership was announced in February 2026; Hann Casino partnership in January 2026.
- **Analysis:** The PAGCOR accreditation is existential — without it, PhilWeb's entire B2B pipeline (Hann, Okada, FBM) would have been voided. The -7.01% decline is a textbook post-announcement sell-the-news reaction from short-term traders, not a fundamental signal. At ₱10.88, the stock is trading well below the intrinsic value of its contracted B2B revenue base: Hann Casino (274 tables, 1,721 machines), Okada Manila (one of the Philippines' largest integrated resorts), and 30,000 FBM machines represent a substantial recurring revenue pipeline just beginning to flow through earnings. The asset-light model means every incremental operator contract is high-margin scale.
- **Stance:** ACCUMULATE WEB. April 1 PAGCOR deadline met — the regulatory gate is cleared. -7.01% decline is the entry. Hann + Okada + FBM (30,000 machines) = the recurring B2B revenue engine. Focus shifts from regulatory to commercial execution in Q2 2026.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

SCC

- SCC (Semirara Mining and Power Corp.) — Consunji Also Chairs SCC; Coal $143.85/ton; April 28 Auction Deadline
- Isidro Consunji's new DHI chairmanship sits alongside his existing roles as chairman of DMCI Holdings and Semirara Mining and Power Corp., reinforcing the Consunji group's identity as a resource-focused conglomerate. SCC is the Philippines' largest domestic coal producer, supplying approximately 60-70% of local coal demand from its Caluya Island mine in Antique. Coal closed at $143.85/ton on 3/30, up 1.30% from the prior session. SCC's integrated mine-to-power model (coal mining plus SLPGC and Southwest Luzon Power generation assets) generates margin on both sides of the fuel chain. The Semirara coal block auction — contested by SMPC, MGEN, and SMGP — has an application deadline of April 28 with winners announced in May. Foreign funds bought SCC on 3/30.
- SCC's FY2025 contribution to DMC Holdings was ₱7.3 billion, down 33% year-on-year due to softer 2024 coal prices and higher production costs. The 2026 environment — coal $143/ton and national energy emergency declared — is materially different.
- **Analysis:** The energy emergency is SCC's best operating environment in years. Domestic coal supply is now a national security priority; Semirara is the irreplaceable source. The integrated mine-to-power model means SCC captures margin at both the mine (higher coal prices) and the plant (higher generation tariffs). The coal block auction is the next binary catalyst — additional blocks would extend reserve life and capacity pipeline beyond current plans.

- **SCC (Semirara Mining and Power Corp.) — Consunji Also Chairs SCC; Coal $143.85/ton; April 28 Auction Deadline**
- **I**sidro Consunji's new DHI chairmanship sits alongside his existing roles as chairman of DMCI Holdings and Semirara Mining and Power Corp., reinforcing the Consunji group's identity as a resource-focused conglomerate. SCC is the Philippines' largest domestic coal producer, supplying approximately 60-70% of local coal demand from its Caluya Island mine in Antique. Coal closed at $143.85/ton on 3/30, up 1.30% from the prior session. SCC's integrated mine-to-power model (coal mining plus SLPGC and Southwest Luzon Power generation assets) generates margin on both sides of the fuel chain. The Semirara coal block auction — contested by SMPC, MGEN, and SMGP — has an application deadline of April 28 with winners announced in May. Foreign funds bought SCC on 3/30.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

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DMC

- **DMC (DMCI Holdings) — Consunji's DHI Chairman Role Adds Mining Holding Dimension; Concreat Cement Recovery; Capex Intact**
- **I**sidro Consunji's appointment as DHI chairman adds a listed mining holding vehicle to his portfolio alongside DMCI Holdings, reinforcing the Consunji group's consolidating resource strategy. DMC's subsidiary Concreat Holdings Philippines is implementing cement price increases of ₱30-40/bag in tranches — structured as a reversible fuel surcharge — following fuel cost escalation from the Middle East conflict. Herbert Consunji (DMCI CFO and Concreat CEO) noted that for every ₱2 fuel increase, there is approximately ₱1 of cement price effect. DMC's 2026 capex stands at ₱24.6 billion (+11% YoY): ₱15.5B for DMCI Homes, ₱3.3B for DMCI Power (44MW new off-grid capacity), ₱2.9B for Concreat plant upgrades, and ₱1.9B for SCC maintenance. DMCI Mining contributed ₱924 million to FY2025 earnings, up 276%, on nickel price recovery and initial operations at the Long Point mine. Foreign funds sold DMC on 3/30 on sector rotation to pure-play energy and gold names.
- Concreat posted a ₱1.9 billion net loss in 2025 from integration costs related to the Cemex acquisition. The cement pricing strategy is the 2026 recovery path.
- **Analysis:** DMC is a multi-engine conglomerate that benefits from the energy emergency across several subsidiaries simultaneously: coal margins via SCC, cement pricing power via Concreat, nickel recovery via DMCI Mining, and now Tampakan optionality via Consunji's DHI chairmanship. The foreign selling on 3/30 reflects sector rotation toward pure-play energy and gold, not fundamental deterioration. The ₱24.6B capex commitment signals confidence in the long-term demand pipeline despite near-term macro headwinds.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

PAL

- **PAL (Philippine Airlines) — Suspends Manila-Riyadh Flights Until April 8; Rolling Gulf Route Cuts Continue**
- **P**hilippine Airlines suspended its Manila-Riyadh flights until April 8 amid the ongoing Middle East conflict, adding to earlier suspensions of Dubai routes (until April 20), Abu Dhabi, and other Gulf corridors. PAL has also implemented frequency reductions across its broader international network through October. The Saudi Arabia corridor — Riyadh, Jeddah, and Dammam combined — is among PAL's highest-volume and highest-margin international segments due to the density of OFW demand, estimated at approximately 3 million Filipinos in the Gulf.
- **Analysis:** PAL's week-by-week suspension strategy preserves scheduling flexibility but signals that the airline has no visibility beyond the immediate near-term on when airspace will normalize. Each week of Riyadh suspension represents an estimated ₱150-300 million in foregone revenue from that route cluster alone. The fuel surcharge escalation to CAB Level 8 (April 1-15) provides partial pass-through to passengers but does not compensate for lost routes. If Gulf suspensions extend through April, PAL's H1 2026 revenue guidance will require downward revision. CEB is structurally better positioned given its 73% domestic route mix.
- S**tance:** NEUTRAL to MONITOR for PAL. Force majeure route cuts are financially material. Watch for the April 8 announcement — if Riyadh suspension is extended again, H1 guidance revision follows.

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	3/27/2026	3/30/2026	%Chg
AC	503.5	500	-0.70%
ACEN	2.76	2.84	2.90%
AEV	29.55	29.5	-0.17%
ALI	17.72	16.26	-8.24%
AREIT	38.85	38.35	-1.29%
BDO	120.4	113.4	-5.81%
BPI	99	96	-3.03%
CBC	64.9	64.8	-0.15%
CNPF	35.2	33.2	-5.68%
CNVRG	12.8	12.3	-3.91%
DMC	9.8	9.99	1.94%
EMI	15.3	15.28	-0.13%
GLO	1,634.00	1,638.00	0.24%
GTCAP	515	506	-1.75%
ICT	696	693	-0.43%
JFC	183.6	177	-3.59%
JGS	26.2	27.5	

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	3/27/2026	3/30/2026	%Chg
LTG	14.68	14.42	-1.77%
MBT	66.3	63.3	-4.52%
MER	609.5	604	-0.90%
MONDE	6.49	6.44	-0.77%
PGOLD	39.5	40	1.27%
PLUS	17.02	16.04	-5.76%
RCR	6.77	6.57	-2.95%
SCC	28.9	28.55	-1.21%
SM	620	590	-4.84%
SMC	71.1	72	1.27%
SMPH	19.32	19.54	1.14%
TEL	1,295.00	1,295.00	0.00%
URC	64.85	65	0.23%

TRENDING STOCKS

DIVIDEND YIELD INDEX (PSE DivY)

	3/27/2026	3/30/2026	%Chg
AREIT	38.85	38.35	-1.29%
CBC	64.9	64.8	-0.15%
CREIT	3.36	3.38	0.60%
DMC	9.8	9.99	1.94%
DNL	3.72	3.55	-4.57%
GLO	1,634.00	1,638.00	0.24%
LTG	14.68	14.42	-1.77%
MBT	66.3	63.3	-4.52%
MER	609.5	604	-0.90%
MREIT	13.68	13.6	-0.58%
NIKL	4.34	4.13	-4.84%
OGP	31.4	31	-1.27%
PGOLD	39.5	40	1.27%
RCR	6.77	6.57	-2.95%
RLC	16.88	16.98	0.59%
RRHI	39.25	46.55	18.60%
SCC	28.9	28.55	-1.21%
SGP	20.95	22.05	5.25%
TEL	1,295.00	1,295.00	0.00%
URC	64.85	65	0.23%

TRENDING STOCKS

PSE MidCap

	3/27/2026	3/30/2026	%Chg
AGI	8.82	9	2.04%
APX	14.7	14.36	-2.31%
AUB	42.1	41.1	-2.38%
BLOOM	2.1	1.99	-5.24%
COSCO	6.78	6.92	2.06%
DNL	3.72	3.55	-4.57%
GSMI	277.8	273.8	-1.44%
KEEPR	2.16	2.12	-1.85%
MEG	2.15	2.06	-4.19%
MREIT	13.68	13.6	-0.58%
MWC	41.95	41.7	-0.60%
NIKL	4.34	4.13	-4.84%
OGP	31.4	31	-1.27%
PNB	57.3	55.65	-2.88%
RLC	16.88	16.98	0.59%
RRHI	39.25	46.55	18.60%
SECB	66.8	65.45	-2.02%
SEVN	34.1	33.7	-1.17%
SGP	20.95	22.05	5.25%
WLCON	6.16	6	-2.60%